TMC

THE MULTIPURPOSE COMPANION

Commander's manual

A practical guide to installation, flight and every TMC tool for Elite Dangerous.

v1.0.3 / English / 2026-11-01

Local journal → **Cockpit panels** → **Your decisions**

Edition for TMC 1.0.3 on 64-bit Windows. Official Linux and Steam Deck support is still in development; this version does not include a Linux installer.

TMC is an information copilot. It reads files produced by the game, brings your information together and suggests actions. You still fly, buy, sell, scan and engineer equipment inside Elite Dangerous.

Elite Dangerous is a trademark of Frontier Developments. TMC is an independent project. This manual contains no official game artwork.

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The interface paths below chapter titles use the application's own translations. Estimates, third-party information and journal state can change during a session. This guide describes the version shown on the cover.

01 / OPERATING GUIDE

Install TMC and make your first flight

In TMC: Settings

Choose TMC-Setup.exe or the portable TMC.exe from the official release. You only need one of these options to get started; community accounts are optional.

Procedure

1. Download from github.com/Danikuso/TheMultipurposeCompanion/releases/latest. Check the version and confirm that this is the official repository before opening a file.
2. Run the installer and launch TMC from its shortcut, or open TMC.exe if you chose the portable version. Select your language in Settings.
3. Enter an Elite Dangerous session until you are in a ship or on foot. Allow the initial history import to finish and check your current system and ship.
4. Open Dashboard to review the information. Closing the window sends TMC to the system tray; use Exit from its tray icon menu to stop the application completely.

Understanding the information

TMC obtains its state from the journal and the game's companion files. Some panels remain empty until you visit a station, open a market, accept a mission or trigger the relevant event.

The usual Windows journal location is %USERPROFILE%\Saved Games\Frontier Developments\Elite Dangerous. If automatic detection fails, check that folder first and keep the original files.

Cockpit tip

An empty card does not mean a zero balance. Wait for the event that updates the information and confirm that you are viewing the correct session.

02 / OPERATING GUIDE

Read the cockpit and find your tools

In TMC: Layouts / Modules

The top bar summarizes your system, flight mode, fuel, hull, cargo and credits. The sidebar separates combined activity layouts from individual modules.

Procedure

1. Choose a layout when you need several tools for the same activity. Open an individual module when you want to focus on its information.
2. Use Dashboard to return to the commander, ship, location, status, route, session and alerts overview. Routes with several jumps do not prevent navigation to this screen.
3. Expand a card's additional information to inspect tables, catalogues or inventories. Collapse the details again when you no longer need them.
4. In Settings, scroll through the content to reach INARA, Frontier CAPI and the lower controls. The mouse wheel and vertical scrollbar work in version 1.0.3.

Understanding the information

The sidebar has its own scrolling area and keeps Settings at the bottom. For a wide table, use the horizontal bar in that table's container; this is separate from the panel's vertical scrolling.

An activity indicator identifies modules with relevant information, but does not stop you opening others. Connection and game-not-running messages help distinguish old information from a fresh update.

Cockpit tip

Read the headline metrics first, then open the detail you need. This avoids hunting for important numbers inside a long table.

03 / OPERATING GUIDE

Auto-companion and tactical lock

In TMC: Settings

Auto-companion suggests a layout based on the activity it detects. It does not perform game actions: it changes the presentation to bring the relevant tools into view.

Procedure

1. Enable Auto-companion in the top bar if you want the cockpit to follow your activity. Disable it to keep a manually selected layout.
2. In Settings, reorder activity priorities using the arrows. Put the role that should win first when several relevant signals are present.
3. Set the retention period between 0 and 60 seconds so you can review results after combat, mining or trading. Predictive transitions and transition cues are optional.
4. Click the padlock or press Alt+L to block switching while studying a route, engineering plan or market. Press it again to allow automatic changes.

Understanding the information

Exploration can switch its context between system bodies and exobiology. You can also select either view using the context buttons when you prefer to inspect it yourself.

Automatic decisions depend on the events written by the game and your priorities. If the screen does not match your intention, open the layout manually and check the padlock state.

Cockpit tip

Before a longer operation in Settings or Engineering, check automatic mode and tactical lock. You do not need to turn off the rest of the copilot.

04 / OPERATING GUIDE

Dashboard and ship inspection

In TMC: Dashboard / Ship

The commander overview brings credits and ranks together; ship, location and status panels put them in the context of your current flight. The Ship view provides a closer inspection of your loadout.

Procedure

1. Check your commander, system and flight mode to confirm that TMC is showing the expected ship and session.
2. Review hull, fuel, cargo and rebuy cost before departure. The status view covers shields, landing gear, hardpoints, cargo scoop, mass lock and power distribution.
3. In Ship, choose the exploration, combat or cargo/mining checklist for your activity. Use it to spot missing equipment before taking off.
4. Open the module breakdown, filter by slot or search by name. An engineered component lets you inspect the recorded modification, grade and experimental effect.

Understanding the information

Equipment lists reflect the most recent loadout event. After changing ships or components, let the game update these records before planning another modification.

The session summarizes jumps, distance, duration and credit changes. It is not a complete accounting ledger: purchases, sales, rewards and other events can all affect your balance.

Cockpit tip

Keep room in your budget for rebuy and operating costs. A purchase recommendation is not a suggestion to spend every available credit.

05 / OPERATING GUIDE

Find ships, shipyards and equipment

In TMC: Ship

The Ship finder lists stations offering a ship or a basket of components. It needs online services enabled and suitable information for the Live galaxy.

Procedure

1. Open Ship and find Shipyards and Outfitting. Use your current system as the reference or enter another system to plan ahead.
2. Select an optional ship and add the required components. Check size, category, rating and weapon mount; a component name alone may not identify the correct item.
3. Apply the pad, permit, planetary base, carrier or discount filters you need. If a Stronghold option is offered, check the power you are pledged to.
4. Search and compare distance, supercruise travel, total cost and budget warnings. Copy the system or prepare a route, then buy the equipment inside the game.

Understanding the information

If no station has the complete basket, TMC can present alternatives for individual items. Do not mistake this list of separate stops for one station selling everything.

External catalogues are snapshots. Stock can change, and a station may require a permit or a landing pad compatible with your ship.

Cockpit tip

Before travelling, confirm both the equipment and the access conditions. Recheck the total cost while keeping enough credits for rebuy.

06 / OPERATING GUIDE

Plan and follow a route

In TMC: Navigation

The route strip shows the next jump and the systems after it. Without an accepted TMC plan, it can follow the route plotted in the game's galaxy map.

Procedure

1. Open Navigation or the Exploration layout. Check the origin and jump range; enter your ship if FSD information is missing.
2. Choose the planning mode: an exact route using your ship's characteristics or a neutron route that takes advantage of those systems.
3. Enter the destination, review efficiency and any available refuelling or injection options, then calculate the plan. Inspect its legs before accepting it.
4. Accept the route and use Copy System to paste the next destination into the game map. With automatic copying enabled, the clipboard advances as you travel.

Understanding the information

An online route needs access to the relevant service. Fuel, cargo, range and access conditions remain the pilot's responsibility; TMC does not operate the ship.

If you leave the planned route, inspect the off-route warning and recalculate when appropriate. Always check whether the next star is scoopable and distinguish white dwarfs from neutron stars.

Cockpit tip

Check fuel before each difficult leg. Being able to copy a destination does not guarantee that your ship can reach it in its current state.

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Explore systems and assess body values

In TMC: Exploration

System Bodies summarizes FSS progress, scanned bodies and estimated cartographic values. It helps you decide where to spend time on detailed surface mapping.

Procedure

1. Enter the system and perform scans in the game. Watch the stars, body count and FSS progress bar update.
2. Compare the current value with the expected value after mapping recommended targets. Also check how many priority bodies remain.
3. Open the additional table to compare body type, distance, signals, markers, advice and scan or mapping values.
4. Map your chosen bodies with the surface scanner and review unsold data before continuing your journey or returning to sell it.

Understanding the information

Stars cannot be mapped with probes. If you have only scanned stars, it may be normal to have no additional mapping value; TMC states that there are no priority bodies.

Credit amounts are estimates based on known information and discovery or mapping assumptions. The final payout is determined when selling in the game; a forecast is not money already received.

Cockpit tip

Set the recommendation threshold to suit your time and objectives. A body without a recommendation can still be worth mapping for your own interests.

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Exobiology: complete your samples

In TMC: Exobiology

The Odyssey exobiology assistant combines body conditions, biological candidates and sampling progress. A candidate species is not confirmation that a specimen is present in front of you.

Procedure

1. Review the body's biological signals and open Exobiology, or switch the Exploration layout's context to that view.
2. Check environmental conditions, candidate species and indicative values. Prepare suitable sampling equipment in the game.
3. After the first sample, use distance and bearing relative to earlier samples to travel to another colony of the same organism.
4. Complete all three samples while respecting the required separation. Check progress and the value awaiting sale before looking for another species.

Understanding the information

The useful separation depends on the organism. Moving far enough from one point does not prove that you are far enough from every previous point; check the sampling status.

First-record markers and multiplied values remain estimates when the necessary confirmation is unavailable. Do not assume a guaranteed bonus solely from first footfall or a candidate list.

Cockpit tip

Use the bearing indicator to move away from the previous sample, but choose a safe path over the terrain. TMC provides guidance; you drive or walk.

09 / OPERATING GUIDE

Engineering, unlocks and materials

In TMC: Engineering

Engineering organizes ship and Odyssey materials, engineer status and projects. The guide addresses access to the engineer first, then the recipe and material trades.

Procedure

1. Select the component or project you want to improve. Choose a blueprint, target grade, experimental effect and expected rolls where applicable.
2. If the engineer is locked, follow discovery, invitation and unlock contribution in order. Copy the engineer's system and review your progress before travelling.
3. Compare stock, missing quantities and amounts covered by trading. Add the project to your shopping list and order its priority.
4. Review trades calculated from surplus materials and the suggested trader or source. Complete the contribution, trade or modification in the game and allow the journal to update.

Understanding the information

Materials reserved for higher-priority projects should not be treated as free surplus. After changing project order or spending materials outside the plan, review the new results.

Rolls per grade are a configurable planning allowance, not a guarantee of the game's outcome. Recipes and access requirements for Odyssey equipment can differ from ship modules.

Cockpit tip

Do not travel to an engineer merely because you own the materials. First verify discovery, invitation and unlock status for the modification you need.

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Combat, hunting, conflict zones and AX

In TMC: Combat

The Combat layout combines target information, your ship's tactical status and session results. Conflict-zone and AX panels add context when those activities have relevant records.

Procedure

1. Target and scan the other ship in the game. Check identity, legal status, faction, shields and hull before deciding whether to fire.
2. Watch your ship's indicators and power distribution. If you target a subsystem, consult the integrity information available from the journal.
3. During a hunt, review kills, vouchers and session progress. Expand the faction breakdown and unclaimed vouchers when planning where to redeem them.
4. In a conflict zone or Thargoid activity, use the relevant panel to track your side, kills and recorded bonds. Review the results before changing activities.

Understanding the information

An incomplete scan or missing target information is not permission to open fire. Copilot alerts supplement the warnings and controls provided by the game.

Outstanding vouchers and bonds have not been redeemed. Expected amounts, fees and nearby services must be considered alongside your legal status and the contact's conditions.

Cockpit tip

Open Crime and Notoriety if penalties appear. Do not try to settle a debt based only on the total shown in your combat session.

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Missions, passengers and sightseeing

In TMC: Missions

Missions groups contracts by destination and highlights deadlines, cargo, rewards and important changes. Specialized panels appear when your contracts need them.

Procedure

1. Review the next destination and each contract's countdown. Copy the system or add it to your route before departure.
2. Check mission goods, cargo room and cabins. Read warnings about wanted passengers and special contract requirements.
3. For massacre missions, inspect faction progress bars and remaining kills. Do not simply add together every mission's kill counter.
4. For sightseeing, compare beacon order and estimated route return. Then track session rewards and contributions to community goals.

Understanding the information

Missions from different factions and missions from the same faction can count kills differently. The grouping helps interpret the whole stack, but final completion is confirmed by the game.

Tourism efficiency depends on your configured reference and known destinations. A shorter route does not remove contract requirements, passenger restrictions or the need to return and hand it in.

Cockpit tip

Check deadlines, cargo and cabins together before taking off. Reaching the correct system is not enough if you left the required goods or passenger behind.

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Mining: choose a target and a buyer

In TMC: Mining

Mining combines deposit selection, prospector analysis, session performance and buyer searches. External targets and prices can be out of date.

Procedure

1. In Mining Targets, select a mineral and method. Adjust access conditions, landing pad and search options for your ship and objectives.
2. Compare the trip to the ring and the proposed sale. Copy the system or calculate a route; local catalogues provide a reference when online services are unavailable.
3. Launch a prospector in the game and inspect composition, core status and verdict. Review your minerals of interest and value threshold if the filter does not match your intentions.
4. Track cargo, limpets and extraction rate. Before selling, compare demand, price age, distance and the station's compatibility with your ship.

Understanding the information

The triangular proposal connects your origin, a deposit and a buyer. It supports a travel decision; it does not automatically mine or execute a sale through TMC.

A large cargo compared with the buyer's demand can reduce the actual sale price. Demand warnings and income estimates still require you to inspect the market on arrival.

Cockpit tip

Bring the necessary limpets and equipment before leaving. A recommended deposit does not replace checking the mining method and local security.

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Trading and multi-stop routes

In TMC: Trade

Trading panels connect the market, your hold, recorded purchase prices and nearby buyers. The most recent local information usually arrives when you open the market in the game.

Procedure

1. Dock and open the market to update its records. Review known opportunities and the age of external references.
2. In My Cargo, compare recorded cost, quantity and possible sale. Distinguish ordinary goods, mission cargo and items marked stolen or illegal.
3. Search for a particular commodity or calculate a trade route. Check what to buy and sell at every stop before accepting the journey.
4. Complete transactions in the game, then review session profit, cargo and the next destination. Use the clipboard to prepare your next jump.

Understanding the information

A calculated profit does not guarantee that the listed price, supply or demand is still available. Supercruise distances and landing pad sizes also affect time and feasibility.

A meaningful profit comparison needs a known purchase cost. If the history cannot establish that cost, avoid confusing gross sale income with actual net profit.

Cockpit tip

Start with a transaction you can verify in the market. Check its result before committing your entire hold to a long trading route.

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Legal status and clearing penalties

In TMC: Crime & Notoriety

Crime and Notoriety brings together penalties, notoriety, illegal cargo and useful contacts. Faction and jurisdiction matter: a combined total alone does not explain where you can pay.

Procedure

1. Open the module and review your legal state, notoriety and the faction breakdown of fines or bounties.
2. Read the clearance guide. If a prerequisite remains outstanding, resolve it before travelling to a neutral contact to attempt payment.
3. When appropriate, locate a compatible Interstellar Factors contact and copy its system. Check the contact's actual services and conditions in the game.
4. If you carry illegal or stolen goods, inspect their breakdown and available black markets. Decide and perform the transaction in the game while watching security warnings.

Understanding the information

Notoriety timers and security response times are guidance based on available information. They do not replace the state shown by the game.

External services may not know every contact or recent service change. Faction, landing pad and access restrictions may also need to be checked before travelling.

Cockpit tip

Distinguish fines, bounties placed on you and combat vouchers you can redeem. These are different concepts even though each can be shown as a credit amount.

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Fleet Carrier fuel, jumps and finances

In TMC: Fleet Carrier

Fleet Carrier panels summarize location, capacity, fuel, jump sequence and upkeep. Available information depends on the events and permissions present in your session.

Procedure

1. Check the Carrier's identity and location, docking access and capacity distribution before preparing an operation.
2. Review tank Tritium and any reserves recorded in cargo. Distinguish fuel ready to use from commodities kept in storage.
3. Schedule the jump in the game. Follow the destination, countdown and cooldown recorded by TMC.
4. Check balance, weekly cost and upkeep coverage. Review these figures after transfers, service changes or substantial purchases.

Understanding the information

An estimated range does not replace checking the available fuel and whether the destination is valid. The panel neither schedules nor performs a jump for you.

Weeks covered are calculated from the known balance and upkeep. After enabling or suspending services, transferring funds or changing costs, wait for an update before relying on the old coverage.

Cockpit tip

Review location, Tritium and upkeep together before a long journey. Having fuel does not automatically mean the Carrier's budget is covered.

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Colonisation, Powerplay and BGS

In TMC: Colonisation / Powerplay 2.0 / BGS

These tools track projects and relationships at system scale. Use them to turn journal percentages and counters into a concrete next action.

Procedure

1. In Colonisation, review construction progress, remaining tonnage and estimated trips based on your current ship's capacity.
2. Open the supply list to identify outstanding materials and prepare purchases. Make deliveries in the game so progress can update.
3. In Powerplay, inspect your power, rank, merits, session progress and next objective. Consult the cycle status displayed by the application.
4. In BGS or System Factions, compare influence, active states and local control. Expand the table when you need a faction-by-faction breakdown.

Understanding the information

Colonisation trip counts are estimates. Free hold space, goods already in transit and other contributors can change actual supply needs.

Influence, political states and the weekly cycle do not necessarily update at the same moment as your actions. An older reading does not prove that a delivery or contribution has already been processed.

Cockpit tip

Always confirm which system the information belongs to. Do not mix one colonisation project's progress with another faction's or power's situation.

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Accounts, synchronization and remote fleet

In TMC: Settings / Accounts & Sync

Connections are in Settings, under Accounts and Synchronization. Scroll through the panel to reach all service cards. No community account is required to use the local journal.

Procedure

1. Enable EDDN only if you want to share supported information with the community. EDDN does not require a personal account or password.
2. For EDSM or INARA, enter that service's key in its own card, save credentials and test the connection when that control is available. Enable only the synchronization you want.
3. For Frontier CAPI, choose Link with Frontier Store and authorize on Frontier's official page. If the return fails, use the manual URL field in the same card.
4. Refresh the remote fleet and inspect each ship, system and station. If recent changes are missing, update the information in the game and request the fleet again.

Understanding the information

INARA identifies the application as The Multipurpose Companion (TMC) and limits requests to two per minute. INARA and EDSM use different keys; Frontier sign-in uses a separate authorization flow.

Never publish keys, OAuth codes, complete callback URLs or pairing QR codes. Legacy galaxy information remains separate, and the corresponding galaxy-data upload functions are disabled.

Cockpit tip

Connect and test one service at a time. This makes it easier to separate credential errors, service delays and authorization problems.

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Spoken alerts and microphone queries

In TMC: Settings

TTS alerts and microphone queries are different functions. You can listen to alerts without speech recognition, or enable both when suitable hardware and engines are available.

Procedure

1. In Settings, enable the voice copilot and choose engine, voice, volume and speech rate. Use the voice test before starting a flight.
2. Choose the alert channels you need: combat, navigation, exploration, mining and Carrier. Configure Auto-companion transition cues separately.
3. To ask questions, allow microphone access and configure recognition. Whisper needs its model downloaded and initialized; then use the listening mode or push-to-talk button.
4. If you use VoiceAttack on Windows, download TMC's generated .vap profile and import it into VoiceAttack. That external application must be installed separately.

Understanding the information

The nine queries cover ship status, fuel, next jump, copying the next system, biological signals, pinned materials, legal status, nearest Interstellar Factors and nearest black market.

The native engine depends on voices installed in Windows. Kokoro needs its worker and resources; check fallback mode if they are unavailable. Missing sound does not by itself mean that the microphone is failing.

Cockpit tip

Test a spoken alert first, then a short query in the selected language. Avoid troubleshooting audio output and speech recognition at the same time.

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Settings, tablets and updates

In TMC: Settings

Settings brings together language, theme, activity preferences, services, voice and application updates. Local network access lets another device on your own network display the cockpit.

Procedure

1. Choose language and theme. Review mapping and mining thresholds, minerals of interest, search radii, tourism reference and engineering rolls for your activities.
2. For a tablet, connect both devices to the same network and enable local access. Open the link from TMC's pairing QR code on the second device.
3. Use the update-check option to query GitHub Releases. Checking at startup and automatically installing are separate choices.
4. When updating, review the version and release notes, download the installer and complete the Windows steps. Reopen TMC and confirm the installed version.

Understanding the information

The pairing QR code or link provides access to your cockpit. Keep it private, use a trusted network and do not expose the service through port forwarding. Remote copy actions use the clipboard on the computer running TMC.

Update checks and model downloads are network operations independent of galaxy data. To work without internet, review those settings and account connections too; do not rely on a single switch.

Cockpit tip

Changing a threshold changes recommendations, not the game's rules. Before saving, check that quantities and units match what you intended.

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Troubleshooting and asking for help

In TMC: Settings

Before deleting configuration or reinstalling, identify whether the missing piece is a journal event, external information, authorization or an application update. Each needs a different solution.

Procedure

1. If information is absent, enter the game and check the top-bar system, import status and journal folder. Open the market or game screen that produces the missing record.
2. If a search returns nothing, review Live/Legacy, online access, pad and permit filters, and data age. Repeating the same request without a pause will not repair an unavailable service.
3. If a tablet fails, check the local network, current pairing link and firewall permission on a trusted network. For CAPI, use the manual return option without sharing its contents publicly.
4. Report an issue through Support in Settings or github.com/Danikuso/TheMultipurposeCcompanion/issues. Include version, language, resolution, steps and expected result; attach only reviewed screenshots.

Understanding the information

In v1.0.3, Settings should scroll to its lower cards and Dashboard should open even with a multi-jump route. If not, confirm that you closed the old instance and launched the updated executable.

Hide commander name, FID, chats, keys and token-bearing URLs in screenshots or logs. Use github.com/Danikuso/TheMultipurposeCompanion/releases/latest for official downloads; a new community account is not needed to fix a local problem.

Cockpit tip

Provide a short reproduction: starting screen, clicks or scrolling, observed result and version. This is usually more useful than an unexplained screenshot.